Next we need to instruct Kustomize to apply the patch. In the kustomization.yml file for the staging overlay of Catalog Service, list the patch-env.yml file as follows.

Listing 14.12 Getting Kustomize to apply the patch for environment variables

```
apiVersion: kustomize.config.k8s.io/v1beta1
kind: Kustomization

resources:
  - github.com/<your_github_username>/catalog-service/k8s?ref=main

 patchesStrategicMerge:        ❶
  - patch-env.yml              ❷
```

❶ Section containing the list of patches to apply to the base manifests according to the strategic merge strategy

❷ The patch for customizing the environment variables passed to the Catalog Service container

You can use this same approach to customize many aspects of a Deployment, such as the number of replicas, liveness probe, readiness probe, graceful shutdown timeout, environment variables, volumes, and more. In the next section, I'll show you how to customize ConfigMaps.

14.3.5 Customizing ConfigMaps

The base `Kustomization` for Catalog Service instructs Kustomize to generate a `catalog-config` ConfigMap starting from an application.yml file. To customize the values in that ConfigMap, we have two main options: replace the entire ConfigMap or overwrite only the values that should be different in staging. In this second case, we could generally rely on some advanced Kustomize patching strategy to overwrite specific values in the ConfigMap.